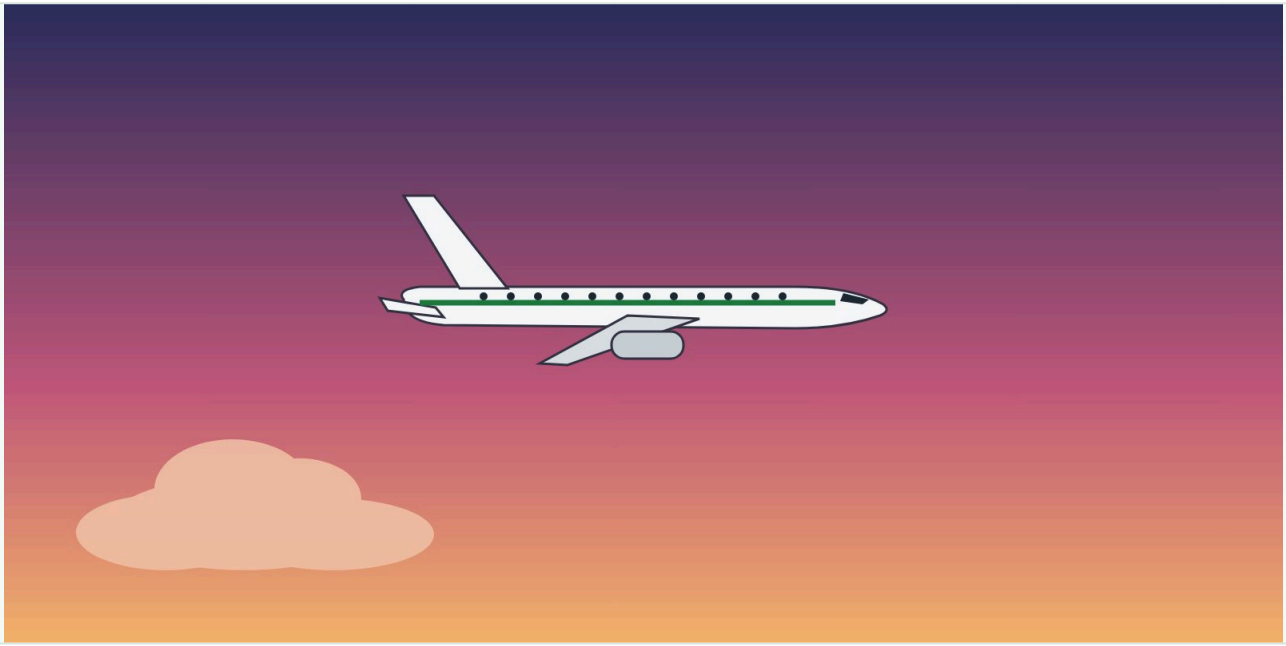
MODULE 2 · PROCEDURES AND PRACTICE

# Lesson 06: Good Practice and Common Errors

Lesson 6 of 6 · about 5 min

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Apply crew procedures that prevent CPDLC errors.
- Recognise common CPDLC errors.
- Manage workload when using CPDLC.



Only one pilot heads-down at any time.

## Crew procedures

1. **Read the whole message** — aloud or silently, as the SOP requires. Conditional clauses ("AT ... CLIMB TO ...", "AFTER PASSING ...") are easy to miss.
2. **Cross-check** it with the other pilot before responding.
3. **Respond** — then set the clearance in the FCU/MCP or FMS, and cross-check the result.
4. If anything is unclear, **revert to voice**.

## Common errors

- Executing a message before responding, or responding WILCO without both pilots reading it.
- Missing a condition in a conditional clearance.
- Responding to the wrong message when several are pending.
- Logon failures caused by wrong flight plan or FMS data.
- Heads-down work with CPDLC at a critical moment — only one pilot should be heads-down at any time.

**WORKLOAD**

CPDLC reduces frequency congestion, but it can increase heads-down time. Plan its use for cruise and for non-urgent exchanges, and keep the pilot flying focused on the flight path.

**KEY TAKEAWAYS**

- Read in full, cross-check, respond, then act — and verify the result.
- Watch for conditional clauses and multiple pending messages.
- Only one pilot heads-down; revert to voice when in doubt.

**KNOWLEDGE CHECK**

**What is the correct order when handling a CPDLC clearance?**

A. Act, then read, then respond

B. Read in full, cross-check, respond, then act and verify

C. Respond, then read

D. Act without responding

**Answer: B.** Read, cross-check, respond, then act and verify.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.